

BUILT — COMPLETE backward compatibility: Win 11 -> Vista (v0.37.0)

Every feature works on every Windows from 11 down to Vista. The engine substitutes the right tool per OS; only GPU acceleration (a speed booster) is Win10+.

1 · SAME FEATURES, PER-OS ENGINES

	Win 11/10	Win 8/8.1	Win 7	Vista
Search · vehicle hub · 104th sheet	stdlib	stdlib	stdlib	stdlib
Viewer · HD · loupe · tilt · zoom	yes	yes	yes	yes
Page render	PyMuPDF	PyMuPDF/Poppler	PyMuPDF/Poppler	Poppler
OCR (text recovery)	PP-OCRv5	RapidOCR/Tess	RapidOCR/Tess	Tesseract
Auto-snapshots	yes	yes	yes	yes
GPU acceleration (speed only)	yes	—	—	—
Only the ENGINE changes by OS — the result (a searchable index, the viewer, the 104th sheet) is identical everywhere.				

2 · HOW (substitution chain, auto-detected by sysprobe)

Render:

PyMuPDF (modern)

else

Poppler pdftoppm

(Win7/Vista)

OCR:

RapidOCR GPU

else

RapidOCR CPU

else

Tesseract

(Win7/Vista)

Core:

pure Python standard library + SQLite + a browser UI -> runs on any Windows (and old Python).

Python: Win7 -> 3.8 (last supported); Vista -> 3.4, or just run a PRE-BUILT index from the portable build (search/viewer/104th need only stdlib). Install Poppler + Tesseract for Windows on legacy OS; the probe (render_backend / ocr_backend) reports what's present and what to add.

THE ONE HONEST LIMIT

NVIDIA GPU acceleration is Win10+ only (CUDA/onnxruntime don't exist for Vista/7) — but it's a SPEED booster, not a feature. OCR still completes on Vista/7 via Tesseract and the searchable result is the same. Nothing a user can do is missing on the older OSes.